

**Session 1 Others & Business- Political science, (9.30am-11am) (1.30 h), National Research Center.
Others**



Prof. Hala Yousry is a Professor of Rural Sociology and former Head of the Social Studies Department at the Desert Research Center in Egypt. She is a member of the Rural Women Committee at the National Council for Women and serves as Chair of the National Steering Committee for the Small Grants Programme (SGP) under GEF/ UNDP.

Prof. Yousry has played a significant regional and international role, serving for eight years as the Country Focal Point, North Africa Representative, and Board Member of the African Forum for Agricultural Advisory Services, part of the Global Forum for Rural Advisory Services. In 2012, she was selected by UN Women to represent Egyptian and Arab women at the Rio+20 Conference, where she was further chosen by the Women Major Group (WMG) under United Nations Environment Programme to deliver a plenary speech.

She is also an founding member of the Board of Trustees of the Egyptian Sustainable Development Forum. Bridging academia, civil society, and government, Prof. Yousry has participated in hundreds of conferences, workshops, and seminars at national, regional, and international levels.

Her research portfolio includes numerous scientific publications and working papers in both Arabic and English, focusing on the social dimensions of desert and rural communities, Bedouin and rural women, climate change, desertification, water and food security, and sustainable development in Egypt and the Arab region. She has received multiple national and international awards and certificates of recognition.

In addition to her academic work, Prof. Yousry is a published writer, a frequent guest in television and radio interviews, and an experienced coach working in Egypt and internationally. She has been active and in good relations with national, regional and international organizations such as UN Women, UNESCO, UNEP, UNDP, ESCWA, IUCN, ICARDA, CEDARE, AARDO and FAO.

Bridging the Gap between Scientific Research and Practical Application

Causes, Challenges, and Strategic Interventions

The continuous growth of scientific research has resulted in an unprecedented accumulation of peer-reviewed publications, research reports, and postgraduate theses across diverse disciplines. Despite this substantial body of knowledge, a significant proportion of research outcomes remains inadequately translated into practical applications, limiting their contribution to economic growth, technological advancement, and societal well-being. This disconnect is particularly evident in strategic sectors such as agriculture, industry, healthcare, environmental management, and other productive and service domains, where evidence-based innovations are urgently needed.

The persistence of this research–practice gap represents not only an inefficient utilization of intellectual capital but also a considerable loss of financial resources and human effort. Scientific research demands substantial investments in funding, infrastructure, expertise, and time. However, in the absence of effective mechanisms for knowledge transfer, technology commercialization, institutional collaboration, and evidence-informed policymaking, many valuable research outputs remain confined to academic archives rather than generating measurable societal and economic impact.

This situation raises a fundamental question: Why does a substantial proportion of scientific research fail to progress beyond publication and into practical implementation? Addressing this question requires a comprehensive understanding of the multifaceted barriers that impede research translation, including institutional constraints, limited academia–industry partnerships, inadequate innovation ecosystems, regulatory challenges, insufficient funding for technology transfer, and the misalignment between research priorities and national or market needs.

This presentation provides a systematic analysis of the underlying causes and challenges that contribute to the gap between scientific knowledge generation and its practical utilization. Furthermore, it proposes an integrated framework of strategic interventions operating at the individual, institutional, industrial, and societal levels. The proposed framework emphasizes strengthening research governance, promoting interdisciplinary and cross-sector collaboration, enhancing knowledge-transfer mechanisms, supporting innovation and entrepreneurship, and aligning scientific research with sustainable development priorities and market demands.

By fostering stronger linkages between researchers, policymakers, industry, and society, these interventions aim to maximize the societal value of scientific research, improve national innovation capacity, enhance economic competitiveness, and accelerate progress towards sustainable development.



Prof.Dr. Heba Soliman Training Director at Port Said University. Professor of Antennas at the Faculty of Engineering. Certified Professional Trainer from the Career Development Center of the American Chamber of Commerce. Certified Professional Manager from the Institute of Certified Professional Managers at James Madison University, USA. Over twenty-five years of experience in training and teaching. Expertise in global university rankings and sustainable development in higher education.

The Future of Science: Training, Employability Skills, and Entrepreneurship

The future of science is being shaped not only by rapid technological advances but also by evolving workforce demands that extend beyond traditional disciplinary expertise. We will talk about the critical role of training, employability skills, and entrepreneurship in preparing scientists for diverse and dynamic career pathways. Emphasis is placed on the integration of transferable skills—such as critical thinking, communication, collaboration, digital literacy, and adaptability—into scientific education and research training. We will highlight entrepreneurship as a powerful mechanism for translating scientific knowledge into societal and economic impact, fostering innovation, and addressing global challenges. By examining emerging trends in academia, industry, and the innovation ecosystem, we will advocate for a future-oriented training model that equips scientists to thrive as researchers, innovators, and leaders. Ultimately, the talk underscores the need for holistic capacity-building approaches that align scientific excellence with employability and entrepreneurial mindsets in an increasingly interdisciplinary and innovation-driven world.



Shaimaa ElBanna is a senior international development and education leader with over 20 years of experience in program management, strategic planning, and high-level stakeholder engagement. She has led and managed multi-million-dollar initiatives advancing education reform, workforce development, and institutional collaboration across government, international organizations, academia, and the private sector.

She currently serves as Director of the Change Leaders Scholarship at the American University in Cairo (AUC), where she oversees a flagship national program supporting talented youth from underrepresented communities. In this role, Shaimaa focuses on enhancing scholars' employability, leadership capacity, and social impact through integrated academic, professional, and community engagement pathways aligned with Egypt's development priorities.

Previously, Shaimaa was Chief of Party for the USAID Egyptian Pioneers Program at AUC, providing strategic leadership for an \$86 million initiative aimed at strengthening education systems, skills development, and economic growth. She led high-level stakeholder engagement, regulatory compliance, and program governance, ensuring alignment with both national priorities and USAID objectives.

Before joining AUC, Shaimaa served as Director of Education at the British Council Egypt, managing a broad education and science portfolio encompassing transnational education, student mobility, and research partnerships. She played a key role in leading the £55 million Newton-Mosharafa Fund and acted as Country Director during 2020 and 2021, overseeing financial and operational management during a critical period.

Across her career, Shaimaa has worked extensively in policy influence, gender equity, business development, and impact assessment. Passionate about capacity building and knowledge exchange, she has contributed to research and publications and continues to shape education and development initiatives with lasting impact in Egypt and beyond.

The Hidden Costs of Women's Careers in STEM: Challenges and Pathways to Inclusion

This research delves into the experiences of women in STEM careers, specifically focusing on the higher costs they face compared to men. Through employing a mixed methods approach, combining quantitative and qualitative methodologies, with a specific focus on incorporating in-depth focus group discussions, the study examines the personal costs resulting from role stereotyping and sex discrimination. This study draws on social career cognitive theory. It investigates the challenges women scientists encounter in balancing their scientific careers with family life and explores the strategies they employ to navigate these conflicts. The study aims to develop a comprehensive understanding of the intersectionality between women's scientific careers and their personal and family lives. The findings shed light on women's experiences in STEM, factors that impact their retention in these fields, and propose intervention strategies for creating a more inclusive STEM workforce.

The research addresses two key questions: how the unequal distribution of responsibilities and freedoms outside of the workplace contributes to the gender gap in the STEM labor force, and what mechanisms have proven successful in retaining women in STEM fields.

The main findings of the study reveals that the unequal distribution of responsibilities and societal expectations outside the workplace contribute significantly to the gender gap in the STEM labour force. Women's caregiving burdens limit their time and energy for pursuing STEM careers, reinforcing stereotypes and discouraging their full commitment. Retaining women in STEM requires robust support systems, including parental support, mentorship, and inclusive environments. Addressing gender biases and barriers to advancement is crucial for promoting women's retention in STEM.

Overall, the research reveals the impact of contextual factors, the significance of support systems, the existence of barriers, and the effectiveness of strategies in promoting women's success in STEM careers. It underscores the need to address societal expectations, biases, and gender disparities to create a more inclusive and supportive environment for women in STEM. Further research can delve into the effectiveness of these strategies and identify additional tactics to enhance success and well-being in STEM careers.



Dr. Bothaina Mahmoud Fouad is an accomplished economist, entrepreneurship and innovation expert, and university lecturer with over 12 years of experience spanning higher education, scientific research, project management, and international collaboration. She holds a Ph.D. in Economics from Ain Shams University, specializing in entrepreneurship, innovation, international relations, technology transfer, and R&D competitiveness.

She currently serves as Lecturer of Entrepreneurship, Soft Skills, and Project Management at New Cairo Technological University (NCTU), Egypt, and as an International Lecturer at Midocean University, UAE. Throughout her academic career, Dr. Bothaina has mentored and supervised numerous student startups and entrepreneurial initiatives, preparing teams for prestigious international competitions such as the Hult Prize, Enactus, and the China–Africa Tech Challenge. She previously held the position of Acting Director of the Research Projects Department at the Electronics Research Institute (ERI), Egypt, where she led strategic research and innovation projects, developed feasibility studies, and contributed to national policy initiatives on technology transfer, innovation, and sustainable economic development.

Dr. Bothaina's professional expertise spans entrepreneurship education, innovation ecosystem development, startup incubation and acceleration, curriculum design, project management, feasibility studies, and technology commercialization. She has built international partnerships with universities, research institutions, and innovation organizations across the United Kingdom, China, South Korea, Japan, the United Arab Emirates, and beyond. She is a Certified Incubator Manager and an active member of leading international professional networks, including the Marie Curie Alumni Association and Daedeok Innopolis (Republic of Korea). In recognition of her expertise in entrepreneurship and vocational education, Dr. Bothaina was honored to represent New Cairo Technological University as an official speaker at the Seminar on Vocational Training, Innovation, and Entrepreneurship for Belt and Road Countries, held in Ningbo, China (11–25 June 2026). There, she presented Egypt's experience in technological education, innovation, entrepreneurship, and vocational training, while engaging with representatives from Belt and Road countries to foster international collaboration and knowledge exchange.

Driven by a strong commitment to empowering young people, Dr. Bothaina is passionate about bridging academia and industry, championing innovation-driven entrepreneurship, and advancing sustainable economic development through education, research, and international cooperation.

Envisioning the Future: The Importance of Entrepreneurship for Women in Science

For many women scientists, the hardest part isn't the discovery—it's what comes next. Turning years of research into a real product, company, or service that changes lives often means navigating a world that wasn't built with them in mind. This abstract looks at why supporting women's entrepreneurship in science matters so deeply, not just for fairness, but for the future of innovation itself. Too often, women scientists hit invisible walls: investors who overlook them, networks that exclude them, and biases that make commercializing their work an uphill climb. When we remove these barriers, something powerful happens—research turns into real-world solutions, whether that's a healthcare breakthrough, a clean energy innovation, or a new agricultural technology that helps farmers thrive. What's remarkable about

women-led ventures is their ripple effect. They tend to give back to their communities, hire more inclusively, and open doors for the next generation of women coming up behind them. And when more diverse voices lead innovation, the solutions we create become richer, more thoughtful, and more responsive to the people they're meant to serve. That's why this work pushes for real investment—in incubators, mentorship, and funding designed with women in mind—alongside policies that finally level the playing field. Because when women have the tools, connections, and confidence to build their own ventures, everyone benefits. At its heart, this is about imagining a future where science truly knows no borders—and where every woman scientist has the chance to shape what comes next.

Bussines-Political Scince



Ms. Gulzar Karybekova is the Director of the Centre of Actual Problems and Development, a public fund based in Kyrgyzstan. She earned a degree in International Relations from the Diplomatic Academy of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Russian Federation in 2011 and a Bachelor's degree in Law from Kyrgyz State National University in 2001, completing an additional year for a 5-year Specialist diploma. In 2013, she received a diploma from the Inter-Parliamentary Assembly of the Commonwealth of Independent States (Saint Petersburg, Russia). She has several scientific publications and has participated as a speaker and moderator in international conferences, workshops, seminars, and forums across Asia-Pacific and Europe.

Imagining What is Possible for the Future; Developing Evidence-Based Governance and Innovation Through Women's Leadership

The Kyrgyz Republic's public sector is challenged by the effects of an economic transition, increasing regional differences, and sustainable development. In order to create sustainable, transparent, and citizen-oriented institutions, it is necessary to integrate evidence-based governance with innovative management approaches and solutions. Young female scientists are leading the change and using political science, management, and technology to innovate.

This abstract describes the leadership roles that young female researchers have in developing innovations for the Kyrgyz Republic's public sector. Through their work, they are expanding digital access to municipal services, using data-driven solutions for implementing policy, and creating participatory engagement opportunities for citizens to be involved in decision-making. The use of science and research-based decision-making is helping young female researchers to improve efficiency and create gender equality in the public sector.

Collaboration at the international level strengthens the impact of the work of young female researchers. Organizations such as Women in Science Without Borders (WISWB) support these initiatives by providing mentorship, global networks, and platforms to create solutions together with peers in other countries.

Empowering women scientists to assume leadership roles in evidence-based governance encourages entrepreneurial thinking within public administration and supports the creation of innovative solutions to social, economic, and environmental issues. By supporting the next generation of women leaders in the Kyrgyz Republic, we can create a public sector that develops, participates in, and co-creates sustainable and equitable policies through innovation, evidence-based decision-making, and collaboration with the global community.



Natalia Montellano Duran, PhD, is a Bolivian biotechnologist and academic leader dedicated to strengthening STEM education, scientific capacity, and gender equity in science. She is currently the Director of the Biotechnology Engineering Program at the Universidad Católica Boliviana “San Pablo” (UCB), Santa Cruz, where she leads academic development, curriculum innovation, and research-based training aligned with national and regional challenges.

Her career in STEM integrates biological sciences, applied research, and higher education leadership. Through teaching, laboratory work, and supervision of undergraduate research projects, she has actively

contributed to building scientific skills, critical thinking, and practical problem-solving in contexts where scientific infrastructure and funding remain limited. Her research output includes peer-reviewed scientific publications across multiple areas of STEM, reflecting an interdisciplinary trajectory that bridges biotechnology, molecular and biological sciences, bioactive compounds, soft matter, and STEM education.

A defining pillar of her trajectory is her commitment to the empowerment and visibility of women in STEM. She served as Chair of the Organization for Women in Science for the Developing World (OWSD) – Bolivia National Chapter (2021–2025), leading the consolidation and expansion of a national network of women scientists and strengthening collaboration with universities, policymakers, and civil society.

Her scientific and academic contributions have been recognized through multiple awards, competitive fellowships, and international distinctions that reflect both her research excellence and leadership in science and education. She was selected as a member of the Global Young Academy (GYA) in 2025, and she is also affiliated with the TWAS Young Affiliates Network (TWAS-TYAN)."

Gender-neutral Scientific Leadership in Bolivia: Evidence-Based Insights on Women's Participation Across the STEM Education and Research Pipeline

Reliable, gender-disaggregated data are essential for strengthening scientific systems in countries where structural inequalities limit the full development of human capital. This study presents the first coordinated national mapping of women's participation in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) in Bolivia, conducted by the IDRC, OWSD-UNESCO and the Bolivian National Chapter between 2024 and 2025. Using a mixed-methods approach, the project combined quantitative surveys ($n = 1,962$) across three key levels; secondary students, university STEM students (including dropouts), and STEM professionals; with qualitative interviews, focus groups, and institutional and policy mapping.

Results show that while women achieve parity in overall tertiary education enrollment and exceed men in graduation rates, they remain significantly underrepresented in STEM fields, comprising only 34.2% of STEM students and graduates. At the same time, women represent a majority of researchers nationally (52.6%), revealing a critical disconnect between educational pathways and scientific workforce participation. Persistent data gaps, limited mentorship, cultural stereotypes, uneven access to resources, and institutional barriers; particularly outside major urban centers; continue to constrain women's entry, retention, and leadership in STEM.

By systematically quantifying where women are present, absent, or lost along the STEM pipeline, this study demonstrates that "counting women in STEM" is not merely descriptive, but a strategic tool for evidence-based policy, institutional reform, and targeted intervention. In a country like Bolivia (low income and multicultural), where scientific capacity remains underdeveloped, understanding gender participation patterns is fundamental to improving STEM enrollment, strengthening research ecosystems, and advancing inclusive and sustainable national scientific development."



Ralitsa Savova is an anthropologist whose main research interests are in the field of migration, labour mobility, cultural heritage, cultural heritage in migration, cultural and scientific diplomacy, international relations, and African studies. She is a PhD Candidate in International Relations, Interdisciplinary Doctoral School, University of Pécs, Hungary; has a Master's degree in the UNESCO Chair in Cultural Heritage Management from the Corvinus University of Budapest, Hungary; a Master's degree in Marketing from the Economic Institute of the Bulgarian Academy of Sciences, Sofia, Bulgaria. She is a Post-graduate in Marketing and Management, the Open University, the Open Business School, MK, England; holds a diploma in Tourism and Travel Agency Management from Cambridge International College, Jersey, Britain; and a Pedagogical Competences diploma from Teacher's Training Department in Varna, Bulgaria. Ralitsa Savova is an Official Representative for Central and Eastern Europe of the European cultural route "Longobard Ways across Europe", Cividale del Friuli, Italy; Member of the International Scientific Committee "Amelio Tagliaferri", Brescia, Italy; Member of the Editorial Committee of the Online journal for History and Historiography "Storia e Futuro - Rivista di Storia e Storiografia", Università di Bologna, Bologna, Italy; Member of the European Network on Regional Labour Market Monitoring (EN RLMM); Member of the European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR), United Kingdom (UK); former Guest-researcher at the Institute for Political Science, Centre for Social Sciences, Hungarian Academy of Sciences. Ralitsa Savova is an editor, co-editor, co-author, or author of 19 books, and 16 scientific journal articles, published in 9 countries: Italy (in Rome, and Pisa); Germany (in Baden-Baden); The Netherlands (in Amsterdam); Estonia (in Tartu); Greece (in Ioannina); Hungary (in Budapest, and Debrecen); Romania (in Iasi); Russia (in Moscow, and St. Petersburg); Bulgaria (in Sofia).

Is Africa really the poorest continent on Earth?

Africa is often called "the poorest continent on Earth." For some of those who claim this, it is an assumption, for others it is a prejudice, and for still others it is an association with the problems and challenges faced by the African people. These challenges include unemployment, hunger, poverty, disease, military conflicts, forced migration, migration due to climate change and natural disasters, etc. Despite the challenges, however, Africa is not a poor continent. It is rich in area and population – it is the second largest and most populous continent in the world after Asia. The African population is growing

by 80 people every minute and between 2015 and 2050, over half of the world's population growth will take place in Africa. Further, the African continent is young in terms of the age of its inhabitants – their average age is 18.8 years and is therefore a continent rich in human resources especially young. Also, Africa is a very rich continent in natural resources and is home to a large part of the planet's mineral resources. Finally, the continent is the fastest growing economy in the world after Asia. Despite Africa's vast resources, the aforementioned challenges exist, including a large portion of the African population living in poverty, and it is the task and cause not only of Africa itself, but also of organizations from other continents, as well as global organizations, to help the people of Africa, and for organizations that are already doing so to continue this work, so that Africa can develop its natural and human resources, so that the population can live better and Africa can be and be perceived not as a poor, but as a rich continent, which it actually is. (My lecture is based on a chapter from a book titled "Is Africa Really the Poorest Continent on Earth?", which was published in 2025 by one of the European Institutes for African Studies).